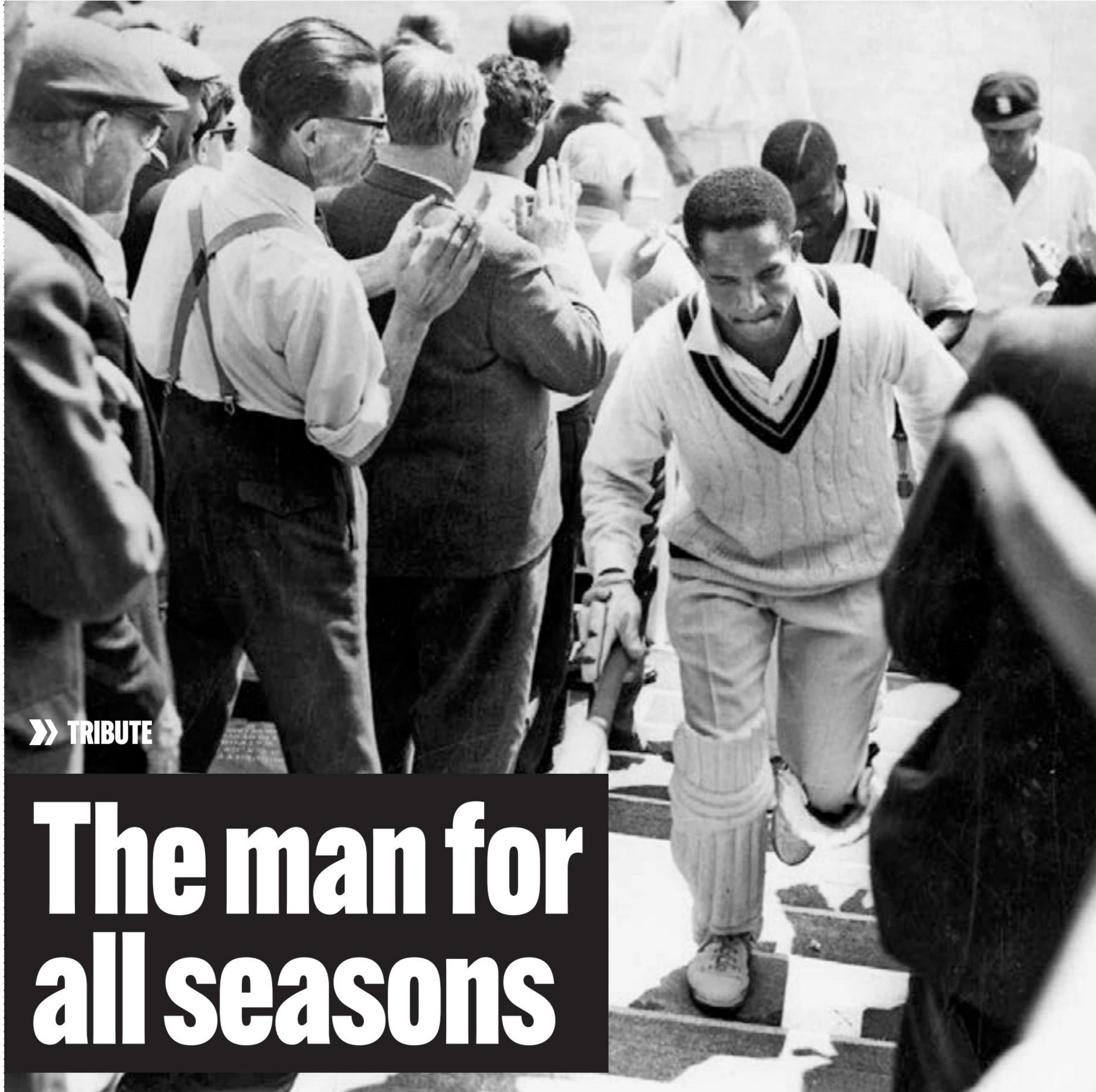




» TRIBUTE

The man for all seasons

He mastered every facet of cricket. **Sir Garry Sobers** leaves behind a legacy of brilliance that generations have admired and few have matched.

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There was nothing he could not do on the cricket field. Garry Sobers, long after Don Bradman had stopped playing, brought a rare culture to the game: the celebration of feats in every department, while respecting the

opponent in equal measure. Sobers loved his own mastery. He loved his rivals' excellence even more.

He was flawless. The crease was his kingdom, and he made it known to his opponents. Nothing could unnerve him.

He had his own way of establishing supremacy, and nothing symbolised it better than his gem of an innings for the Rest of the World

against Australia in Melbourne in 1972.

"The best innings I have seen in Australia," Bradman had described that epic as Sobers tore into the attack spearheaded by Dennis Lillee. The swing of the bat matched the flow of the ball, and the innings was hailed universally as a masterclass. You had to be Sobers to bat like that.

An Australian fan who witnessed